AL MIRATH

UAE Investment Gateway for East Africa 2023

Trade connectivity, capital pathways and real estate opportunity signals

Corporate Expansion & Real Estate Opportunity Intelligence

Prepared from the Al Mirath analytical dataset | Reporting cut-off: 2023

Data discipline: bilateral UAE-East Africa trade figures in the supplied Trade Analysis workbook are modelled presentation values, not verified customs totals. Source-dated UAE-linked investment examples are identified separately and used as evidence of gateway activity.

Executive Summary

Modelled 2023 trade	Exports to UAE	Imports from UAE	Trade balance
$21.2B	**$11.6B**	**$9.6B**	**$2.0B**
19-market UAE model	modelled 2023	modelled 2023	modelled surplus

- The dataset positions the UAE as a commercial gateway connecting East African production, consumption and infrastructure markets with Gulf capital, ports and re-export networks.
- In the workbook's modelled 2023 bilateral table, total East Africa-UAE trade is $21.2B, with Kenya, Tanzania, Ethiopia and Uganda forming the largest modelled corridors.
- Source-dated project evidence shows UAE-linked operators already participating in regional logistics and industrial infrastructure: DP World in Rwanda and Tanzania, and IFFCO in the Berbera Economic Zone.
- For real estate strategy, the gateway thesis is strongest where trade flows intersect with ports, inland logistics, industrial parks, distribution facilities, cold chain and urban consumption.
- The central due-diligence requirement is to separate real, source-dated projects from modelled trade allocations and dashboard scenario values.

Gateway thesis: use UAE connectivity as a screening lens for logistics, industrial and trade-oriented real estate - not as proof that a specific site, rent, valuation or transaction is verified.

1. Why the UAE Matters as a Gateway

2023 macro anchor and commercial positioning

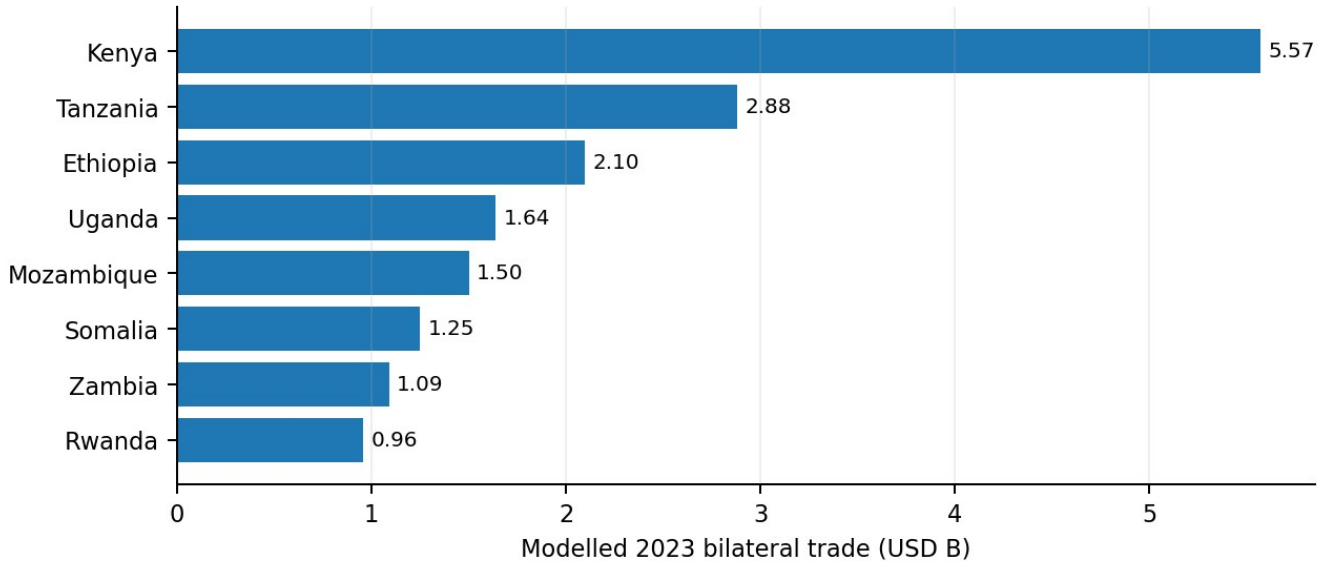
UAE GDP	GDP growth	GDP per capita	FDI inflows
$522.6B	**4.3%**	**$49,851**	**5.9%**
2023 current USD	2023	2023	share of GDP

- The UAE combines a large, high-income economy with globally connected ports, logistics operators, airlines, financial institutions and free-zone structures.
- Within the Al Mirath dataset, UAE-linked companies appear in port concessions, inland logistics, industrial-zone manufacturing and retail/hospitality expansion pathways across East Africa.
- This makes the UAE useful as both a capital origin and a distribution/re-export node when screening East African corporate expansion and property demand.

Source: Macro_Source_2019_2023 in the supplied Al Mirath real-estate workbook. Imported user data; not independently reverified in this report.

2. East Africa-UAE Trade Connectivity

Workbook model - 2023 cut



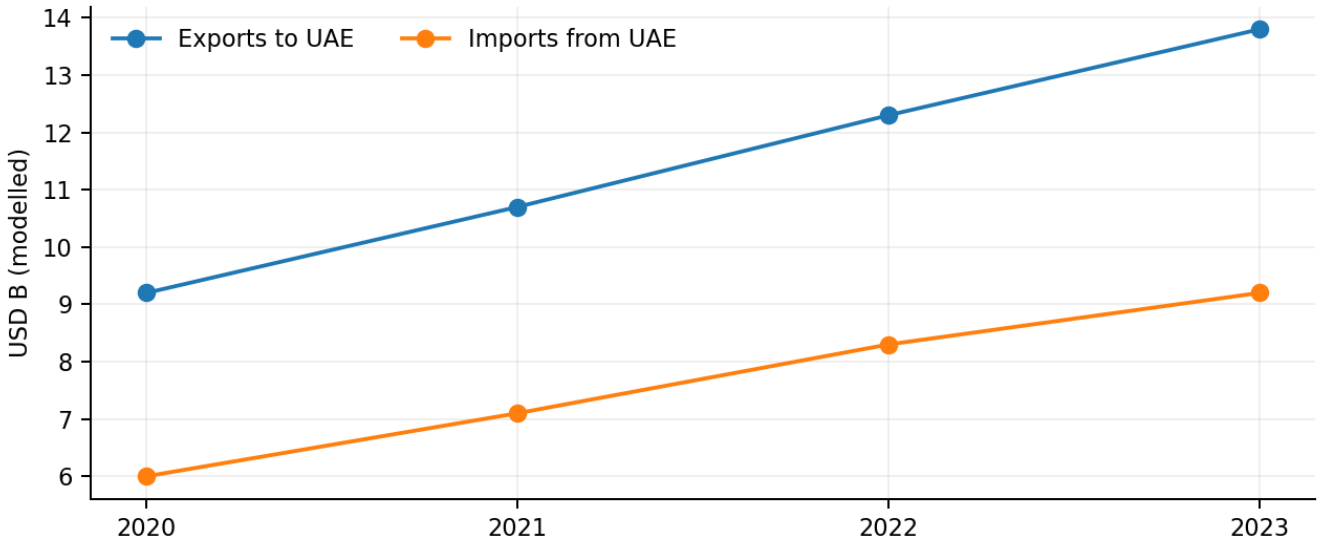
Modelled values from Trade_UAE_Country. The workbook states that the 2023 bilateral country split is back-cast/modelled and not directly available in the source workbook.

Market	Trade (USD B)	Share	Balance (USD B)
Kenya	5.57	26.2%	0.66
Tanzania	2.88	13.6%	0.34
Ethiopia	2.10	9.9%	0.16
Uganda	1.64	7.7%	0.26
Mozambique	1.50	7.1%	0.17
Somalia	1.25	5.9%	0.36
Zambia	1.09	5.1%	0.18
Rwanda	0.96	4.5%	0.09

- Kenya represents about 26.2% of the modelled 2023 bilateral trade table, making it the largest single corridor in the presentation model.

- Tanzania and Ethiopia form the next-largest modelled corridors, reinforcing the relevance of Indian Ocean ports, inland distribution and manufacturing-linked flows.
- The model should be used for dashboard prioritisation only; investment underwriting requires verified bilateral customs and transaction data.

3. Modelled Trade Direction, 2020-2023



Trade_UAE_Trend is explicitly labelled Modelled in the supplied workbook. The series is a presentation construct rather than an independently verified customs time series.

- The model shows both export and import flows rising from 2020 through 2023, with exports to the UAE remaining above imports from the UAE across the period.
- The 2023 modelled trade balance is approximately $2.0B in favour of East Africa in the workbook presentation model.
- For real estate, stronger two-way flows would generally support demand for port-adjacent logistics, inland depots, warehousing, light industrial space and trade-service infrastructure - but location-specific demand must be evidenced separately.

4. UAE-Linked Gateway Investments

Source-dated examples available by the 2023 cut-off

2019 Rwanda	**Kigali Logistics Platform** DP World - Operational inland logistics platform under a 25-year concession.
2022 Somalia / Somaliland	**Berbera Economic Zone** IFFCO - 300,000 sq ft edible-oil packing plant announced inside DP World's economic zone.
2023 Tanzania	**Dar es Salaam Port** DP World - 30-year concession to operate multi-purpose terminals; source cites initial investment exceeding $250M.

- Rwanda demonstrates the inland-logistics gateway model: the Kigali Logistics Platform links a landlocked market to regional trade corridors through a UAE-origin operator.
- The Berbera example shows how an economic zone can convert port connectivity into an industrial occupancy requirement, with IFFCO announcing a large packing plant in 2022.
- The 2023 Dar es Salaam concession is the clearest source-dated gateway signal in the supplied data: DP World entered a 30-year operating concession and the source cites initial investment exceeding $250M.

Sources are carried in the Company_profile and Infrastructure sheets of the supplied Al Mirath workbook. These examples are source-dated 2019, 2022 and 2023 respectively.

5. Real Estate Opportunity Implications



- Port and terminal investments can create secondary demand for container yards, customs facilities, bonded warehousing, truck staging and last-mile distribution.
- Industrial zones linked to ports and major corridors can attract food processing, FMCG packaging, building materials, light manufacturing and export-oriented tenants.
- Landlocked markets can still participate in the gateway model when inland container depots and dry ports reduce friction between coastal gateways and domestic demand centres.
- UAE-origin consumer and hospitality operators create a second channel of property demand beyond logistics, but the supplied 2023-cut evidence is thinner and should be treated as a secondary theme.

Priority screening lens: ports / SEZs + manufacturing or distribution signals + strong corridor connectivity + source-dated corporate expansion. These four elements together are more decision-useful than any single dashboard score.

6. Markets to Prioritise for UAE Gateway Screening

Market	Why it matters	Next diligence step
Kenya	Largest modelled 2023 bilateral corridor; regional services and logistics hub.	Verify bilateral trade, port-linked land and active UAE-origin occupier demand.
Tanzania	DP World Dar es Salaam concession is a source-dated 2023 gateway signal.	Focus on port, hinterland logistics and industrial/SEZ spillover.
Rwanda	Operational DP World Kigali Logistics Platform demonstrates inland gateway infrastructure.	Screen logistics, light industrial and regional distribution around Kigali.
Somalia / Somaliland	IFFCO plant at Berbera Economic Zone connects UAE-origin manufacturing with port-zone infrastructure.	Verify zone occupancy, utilities, security and tenant pipeline.
Ethiopia	Large economy and high modelled bilateral trade ranking.	Gateway case depends on verified trade flows and corridor access through regional ports.

- The ordering above is a screening framework, not an investment ranking.
- Kenya and Ethiopia are supported mainly by the modelled bilateral table, whereas Tanzania, Rwanda and Somalia/Somaliland have clearer source-dated UAE-linked project evidence in the supplied data.

7. Risks, Methodology and Data Notes

Key risks

- Model risk: the bilateral East Africa-UAE country values and trend series are explicitly marked Modelled in the trade workbook.
- Timing risk: some investment-tracker records use modelled tracker years even when the underlying source event occurred later. This report therefore relies on source-dated examples for its 2023 cut-off claims.
- Property evidence risk: corporate investment and trade infrastructure do not establish available land, rent, vacancy, capital value or transaction pricing.
- Execution risk: port/SEZ concessions can take years to translate into occupier demand and must be assessed alongside utilities, customs processes, transport links and political/regulatory conditions.

Data treatment

Dataset component	Treatment in this report
Trade_UAE_Country / Trend	Used as modelled presentation values; clearly labelled as such.
Macro_Source_2019_2023	Used for the 2023 UAE macro anchor; imported user data.
Company_profile	Used for source-dated UAE-origin company expansion examples.
Infrastructure	Used for source-dated logistics infrastructure evidence, including Kigali Logistics Platform.
Investment tracker	Used cautiously; tracker years can be modelled, so later-source records are not treated as historical 2023 proof.